

Regular Meeting
Monday, January 14, 2019
Medford School Committee
Council Chambers

Present: Ms. DiBenedetto, Ms. Mustone, Mr. Ruggiero, Mr. Ruseau, Ms. Van der Kloot, Mayor Burke, Superintendent Dr. Edouard-Vincent, Associate Superintendent Diane Caldwell, Assistant Superintendent Kirsteen Patterson, and High School student representative Chioma Opara.

Roll Call and Salute the Flag - Mayor Burke called the meeting to order at 7:06 PM. 7 - Present, 0 - Absent.

Nominations for Vice Chair - Ms. DiBenedetto nominated Ms. Kreatz, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot.

Roll Call Vote: 7 - Affirmative, 0 - Negative, Ms. Kreatz will be the Vice Chair for 2019.

Nominations for Secretary - Ms. Kreatz nominated Ms. Mustone, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot.

Roll Call Vote: 7- Affirmative, 0 - Negative, Ms. Mustone will be the Secretary for 2019.

Approval of Minutes of January 7, 2019 - Motion to approve by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

Approval of Bills/Transfer of Funds - Motion to approve by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto.

Roll Call Vote: 7 - Affirmative, 0 - Negative, motion passes.

Approval of Payrolls - Motion to suspend the rules by Ms. Kreatz, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto, Approval of Payrolls to be moved from Executive Session.

Ms. DiBenedetto requested that job titles and descriptions be added to this report. Ms. Patterson informed the Committee that this is not possible with the reporting software that is available. Mr. Ruggiero is concerned that there may be employees being paid who do not exist. Ms. Patterson assured him that the Business Office serves as a check and balance with the software and all

paychecks go to living employees. Motion to table the paper by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion granted.

Report of Secretary: Ms. Kreatz - Thank you to all the people in City Hall who helped me as Secretary and congratulations to the next Secretary. Motion to accept the report and place on file by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion passes

Report of the Rules Subcommittee - December 17, 2018 - Ms. Kreatz - We will come back to address this matter at a later date, motion to accept offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Mr. Ruggiero, motion passes.

Committee of the Whole - January 7, 2019 - Mayor Burke - A meeting of the Committee of the Whole was held to discuss the Climate Assessments conducted by AIP of the McGlynn Middle and Elementary Schools. They have had a tremendous turnaround over the past few months. The McGlynn is doing well, it was an overall very good and positive report. There are areas that need to be addressed and we will do so. Motion to accept and place on file by Ms. Kreatz, seconded by Mr. Ruggiero, motion passes.

Report of the Superintendent:

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - There will be a meeting on Thursday, February 7th, at 5:30pm in the McGlynn school auditorium: the new look of nicotine addiction, how to protect your children from this latest trend. All parents and guardians in the district are invited. It is an adults-only event, in collaboration with Toni Wray and Team Medford.

Last Tuesday Mayor Burke and I went to meet with Mayor Walsh in Boston, to discuss an overhaul of the state's school funding formula. Additionally, last Wednesday Mayor Burke and Kirsteen Patterson went to the State House to support the Education Promise Act. It would hugely benefit our district, I am hopeful it goes through.

I attended NSIP training, my 5th session. I continue to work with about 40 superintendents across the state on professional development. Looking at data and potential theories of action. I continue to benefit from hearing from others to guide the work I'm doing. My next meeting will be on February 6.

Medford's computer science curriculum. We are expanding K-12 access, this year coding and robotics have been expanded to all K-8 schools. This program teaches students computational thinking and computer programming in an age appropriate way. These robots are suitable for students from kindergarten all the way through high school.

Priscilla's Pantry - Medford High School Hope Chest, assists Medford High and Vocational Technical High School students. They served lunch to students during the early release day, when lunch is not served in the cafeteria. They served chili and also gave students the ingredients to cook it themselves at home.

Distracted driving presentation - Presented by the Massachusetts Academy of Trial Attorneys. Important information was shared that all it takes is a few seconds of distraction to be fatal.

Math Learning Walk 2 - In collaboration with Lesley we did baseline data in the fall and we are getting ready to do our midyear check in. We are combining teams, having directors and administrators and leaders from Lesley to gather data from the start of the school year to the midpoint.

Mr. Ruggiero - How is the parents vaping event being advertised? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - We will have it on our website. They are notifying parents at the school. There will be a dance happening at the same time so when parents drop their students at the dance parents can go to the auditorium at the same time.

Mayor Burke - More information on the Foundation Budget Education bill: When you net out what we get in school funding against charter school expenses, we are negative. The state is contributing less and less to schools so property tax covers about 80% of school bills. It's disparate compared to suburban schools. We need the extra help. I urge you as this bill progresses to push hard, call your legislators. It lifts everyone up. Stay apprised and tune in for further discussions. Mr. Ruggiero - What is the bill number? Mayor Burke - I will send it to you tomorrow.

Ms. DiBenedetto - Can we do an auto call to the middle school parents the night before to remind them the vaping meeting is happening? Diane Caldwell - There will be an auto call going out, it's already planned.

Ms. Van der Kloot - We are going to meet and greet before the Medford Family Network Valentine's Festival. Can we ask Lisa Evangelista to announce that?

Ms. DiBenedetto - How many homeless students are we serving with Priscilla's Pantry? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I can get you the number of students who attended. Mr. Ruggiero - It would be interesting to know how many families are affected by the government shut down and it would be interesting to know how Priscilla's Pantry can assist. Ms. Van der Kloot - I am more interested in confidentiality of students. Dr. Edouard-Vincent - We can share just numbers and

protect student confidentiality. Ms. Van der Kloot - Just because we are interested in students and numbers doesn't mean we want to discourage students from attending.

Report on Kindergarten Registration - Ms. Caldwell - We are preparing for our 2019 Kindergarten students. Building Bridges to Kindergarten is a great presentation for families. We will hold kindergarten open houses at each elementary school. Ms. DiBenedetto - Will there be interpreters at open houses? Ms. Caldwell - Yes, Haitian Creole and Portuguese. Ms. DiBenedetto - Will there be sufficient staffing? Later hours for interpreters? Ms. Caldwell - Yes, interpreters will have extended hours during vacation week in April, families can call in and make appointments. Ms. Van der Kloot - Can you indicate that before and after school programs are not free or guaranteed on the parent form? Ms. Caldwell - Yes. Mr. Ruseau - Is building bridges for all schools? It's confusing. Can you clarify? On advertisement page can you say Informational Meetings for Parents/Guardians of ALL Incoming Kindergarten Students? Ms. Caldwell - Yes. Ms. DiBenedetto - I would like a report on the number of students on wait lists for before and after school programs. It seems we are not meeting the needs of our district. Ms. Caldwell - It is difficult to get staff for these programs because the hours are challenging. Meghan Fidler-Carey can work on that for you. Mr. Ruggiero - Can you include a url on the shet? Ms. Caldwell - Yes. Motion to accept the report and place on file by Mr. Ruggiero, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto, motion passes.

Recommendation to Approve Field Trip - Audrey Feitor - We have been doing this trip every other year. Students attend courses on science at Disney World. This would be my third time doing this trip. I like to give parents as much notice as possible to budget and save for the trip. I will have our first student interest meeting next week and a parent meeting in early February. Motion to approve field trip offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot.

Roll Call Vote:

6 - Affirmative: Ms. Mustone, Ms. DiBenedetto, Ms. Van der Kloot, Ms. Kreatz, Mr. Ruggiero, Mayor Burke

1 - Abstain: Mr. Ruseau

0 - Negative

Motion passes.

Report on English Language Learners - Paul Teixeira - ELE 5 has been corrected and is now in compliance. Our work with Lesley University has been successful, giving us a leg up like a first year student coming in as a second year. We are able to decrease the number of days we are testing our students so we can focus on teaching them. DESE has a complex system for establishing these regulations. We get results in June, they won't give us the targets until over the summer. I will give a similar report on where it lands next year. Ms. Mustone - Why did all the

elementary schools participate except the Brooks? Mr. Teixeira - There aren't enough students at the Brooks to contribute to the numbers, to get a goal. I can look at individual students to see who is making progress and who is not. Everyone gets a progress monitoring form. Mr. Ruggiero - What languages are they coming in speaking? Mr. Teixeira - Most common is Portuguese, then Haitian Creole, then Spanish and Arabic tied. Mr. Ruggiero - How many Arabic? We don't have translations to Arabic, maybe someone can help us. Can you get those numbers? Mr. Teixeira - Many of our Arabic speaking families come for medical procedures and work with an organization that helps translate Arabic to English for them. Ms. Mustone - How many EL teachers do you have in each of the elementary schools? If the Roberts, McGlynn, and Columbus have more teachers do Brooks students not go there because of EL access? Mr. Teixeira - At Brooks there is an EL teacher in Kindergarten, one in 1st grade, and one that covers 3-5. At McGlynn they have one each for grade 3, 4, and 5 students. We have 3 at the McGlynn and they're all pull out. At Columbus we have 3 teachers, all pull out. Roberts has one dedicated teacher per grade in 3, 4, 5 and two pull outs.

[Added for clarification by Paul Teixeira]

Brooks - three teachers

Grade 1 Newcomer

Grade 2 Newcomer

Grades K - 5 Pull-out (I believe I said 3- 5 in the presentation, but she actually services all pullout students in grades K - 5)

McGlynn - three teachers

Three teachers are pullout that cover grades K - 5

Columbus - three teachers:

Three teachers are pullout and cover grades K - 5

Roberts - five teachers

Grade 3 Newcomer

Grade 4 Newcomer

Grade 5 Newcomer

Two teachers are pullout and cover grades K - 5

Powerpoint presentation: Medford reflects overall trend of EL students increasing year over year. After students complete EL program we continue to monitor them for 4 years as Former EL or FEL. We are increasing the number of EL students by about 20% each year. Motion to accept the report and place on file offered by Mr. Ruggiero, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

Follow-up report on obesity numbers - Toni Wray - Students tend to be overweight in grade 4 and eventually even out, but students who are obese tend to stay that way through grade ten. We address this with health programs and physical education programs in the district. I have information about the Malden YMCA and their program offered to Medford residents for families to attend together. It marries physical education with nutrition, meal planning, and healthy eating habits. The information is on our website and available at school nurses' offices. Mr. Ruggiero - These numbers are not specific to Medford. Ms. Wray - These numbers are reflective of national rates. Mr. Ruggiero - I would like to hold a Committee of the Whole meeting to address this issue. We can't do nothing. Perhaps experts can speak to us on what to do. Ms. Wray - We are not doing nothing. We look for people to come speak, there are programs through the Children's Hospital. Mr. Ruggiero - I didn't mean to imply that you're doing nothing. I mean this is distressing. Motion to have a Committee of the Whole to address policies we can put in place to address the obesity epidemic offered by Mr. Ruggiero, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto, motion passes.

Informational Report on Attorney General's PTO Seminar - Kirsteen Patterson - I just submitted the link and information to be posted on the blog and Medford Schools website to click on and enroll. There is a community engagement set of webinars, they are all free. Time has changed slightly, January 22nd at 10:30am. People need to register with Emily Lazzaro in the Superintendent's office. Ms. DiBenedetto - Do we tell them they need to register in order to use our name? Ms. Patterson - This is a self reporting function at this time. We are requesting it but we don't have every contact person. Ms. DiBenedetto - Actually the committee voted that it's mandatory to report with us. We need to reach out to the principals. It's mandatory. I keep hearing that it's voluntary, but it's not. They need to be listed with us. The deadline is February 1st. We need to tell them all. Dr. Edouard-Vincent - We will be reporting in February. Ms. Kreatz - Will the webinar be recorded? KP - No this is the Attorney General's office. They're doing live question and answer. That is the date and time. Ms. Van der Kloot - Can you ask them to record it? Can we put a letter together to ask them to record it? Mr. Ruseau - This is a pilot training. We wouldn't want to record pilot training because it will be full of off topic questions and trials. Ms. Patterson - I can ask them. Motion to accept the report and place on file offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

Report on High School Heating - John McLaughlin - The theater heat is running again. A custom coil had to be replaced. Now it's too hot. We have an electrician coming in to install a thermostat. Ms. Kreatz - Is there a classroom where students have to wear their coats? Mr. McLaughlin - The report mentions that the vocational school has issues with pipes. Last week it broke again, we keep fixing it. Ms. Mustone - Can you ask a plumber what the cost would be to replace the pipe so we're not playing catch up? Mr. McLaughlin - Yes. It will be a major capital improvement. Ms. Mustone - Can we get a number so we know what we're starting from?

Motion to accept the report and place on file offered by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes.

Motion to move negotiations and legal matters to the end offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

Ms. Van der Kloot - Can future thank you letters list names of Medford School Committee members? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Would you like to sign them? Ms. Van der Kloot - No, just list our names as a courtesy.

Motion to go into executive session offered by Mr. Ruggiero, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto.

Roll Call Vote: 7 - Affirmative, 0 - Negative, motion carries. We will now enter executive session in room 207.

Motion to Accept the Nurses' contract and to send it to the floor offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Mr. Ruseau.

Roll Call Vote: 7 - Affirmative, 0 - Negative, motion passes.

Motion to accept Kids Corner contract and send it to the union for final approval offered by Mr. Ruggiero, seconded by Ms. Kreatz.

Roll Call Vote: 7 - Affirmative, 0 - Negative, motion passes. This will remain in executive session until the union ratifies it.

Motion to exit executive session offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Mr. Ruggiero.

Roll Call Vote: 7 - Affirmative, 0 - Negative, exited executive session at 9:12pm.

Motion to accept the nurses contract offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Kreatz.

Roll Call Vote: 7 - Affirmative, 0 - Negative, motion passes. Meeting adjourned at 9:12pm.